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MEMO

Date: **November 7, 2025**

To: Facilities Improvement and Operations Committee

CC: Dr. Kimberlee Armstrong, Superintendent

From: Tom Odgers, Chief of Integrated Operations

Subject: Portland Clean Energy Fund (PCEF) Update

BLUF (Bottom Line Up Front)

Portland Public Schools (PPS) received **$19.9 million** from the *Portland Clean Energy Community Benefits Fund (PCEF)* under the City's **Climate Investment Plan (SP16 – Climate Friendly Public Schools)**.
Of this, **$10 million** is tied to the *Portland Association of Teachers (PAT)* agreement for HVAC and thermal comfort projects approved by a PAT representative.
To date, **$700,000** in scope has been approved and implemented, with the next phase planned for **2026 and beyond**.

Background

PCEF was approved by **65% of Portland voters in 2018** to support community-led climate initiatives emphasizing equity and environmental justice.
In Fall 2023, the City launched the **Climate Investment Plan (CIP)** to guide PCEF spending.

PPS was awarded:

- **$16.9 million** for facility improvements (34 schools), and
- **$3 million** for student-led projects (40 schools, grades 6–12).

The PAT agreement requires **$10 million of the $16.9 million** to be directed toward HVAC and thermal comfort improvements approved by a PAT representative.

Current Status (as of September 2025)

PPS and **McKinstry** are implementing **$700,000** of approved lighting and weatherization work, with completion expected by the end of 2025.
Planning for **2026–2028** includes additional HVAC, energy efficiency, and green schoolyard measures.

Category	Allocation	Status
Physical Improvements	$16.9M	$700K approved; remainder in planning
Student-Led Projects	$3.0M	Planning and selection phase
Total PCEF Award	**$19.9M**	**In progress**

Risks & Next Steps

Risks

- Dual-approval process (**PCEF + PAT**) may slow delivery.
- Rising costs could limit project scope.
- Coordination required with bond and OSM programs.

Next Steps

- Finalize **2026–2028 project package**.
- Integrate projects with PPS **sustainability portfolio**.
- Deliver **quarterly progress reports** to PCEF, PAT, and the PPS Board.